kernel

things programs on portal shouldn’t do

read other user’s files

modify OS’s memory

read other user’s data in memory

hang the entire system

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privileged operation: problem

how can hardware (HW) plus operating system (OS) allow:

- read your own files from hard drive

but disallow:

- read others files from hard drive

some ideas

OS tells HW 'okay' parts of hard drive before running program code

- complex for hardware and for OS

OS verifies your program's code can't do bad hard drive access

- no work for HW, but complex for OS
- may require compiling differently to allow analysis

OS tells HW to only allow OS-written code to access hard drive

- that code can enforce only 'good' accesses
- requires program code to call OS routines to access hard drive
- relatively simple for hardware

some ideas

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kernel mode

extra one-bit register: “are we in *kernel mode*”

- other names: privileged mode, supervisor mode, …

not in kernel mode = *user mode*

certain operations only allowed in kernel mode

- *privileged instructions*

example: talking to any I/O device

what runs in kernel mode?

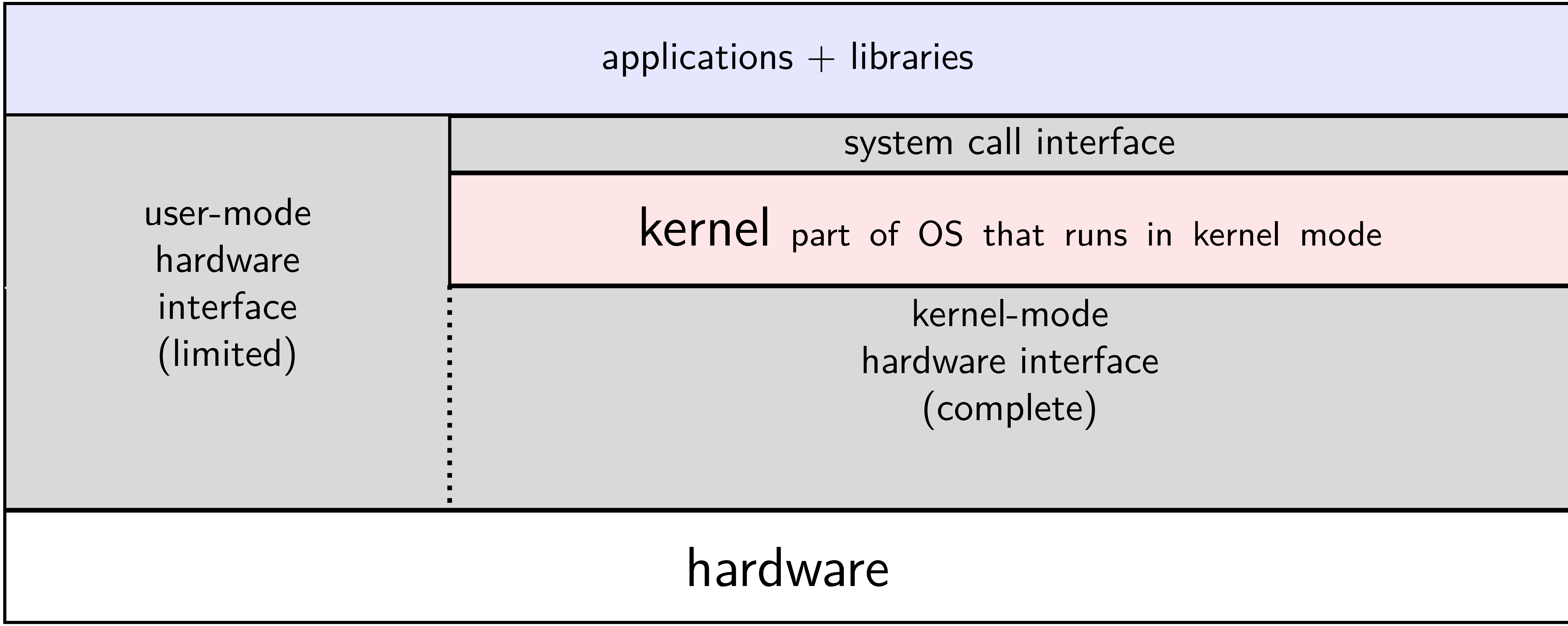
system boots in kernel mode

OS switches to user mode to run program code

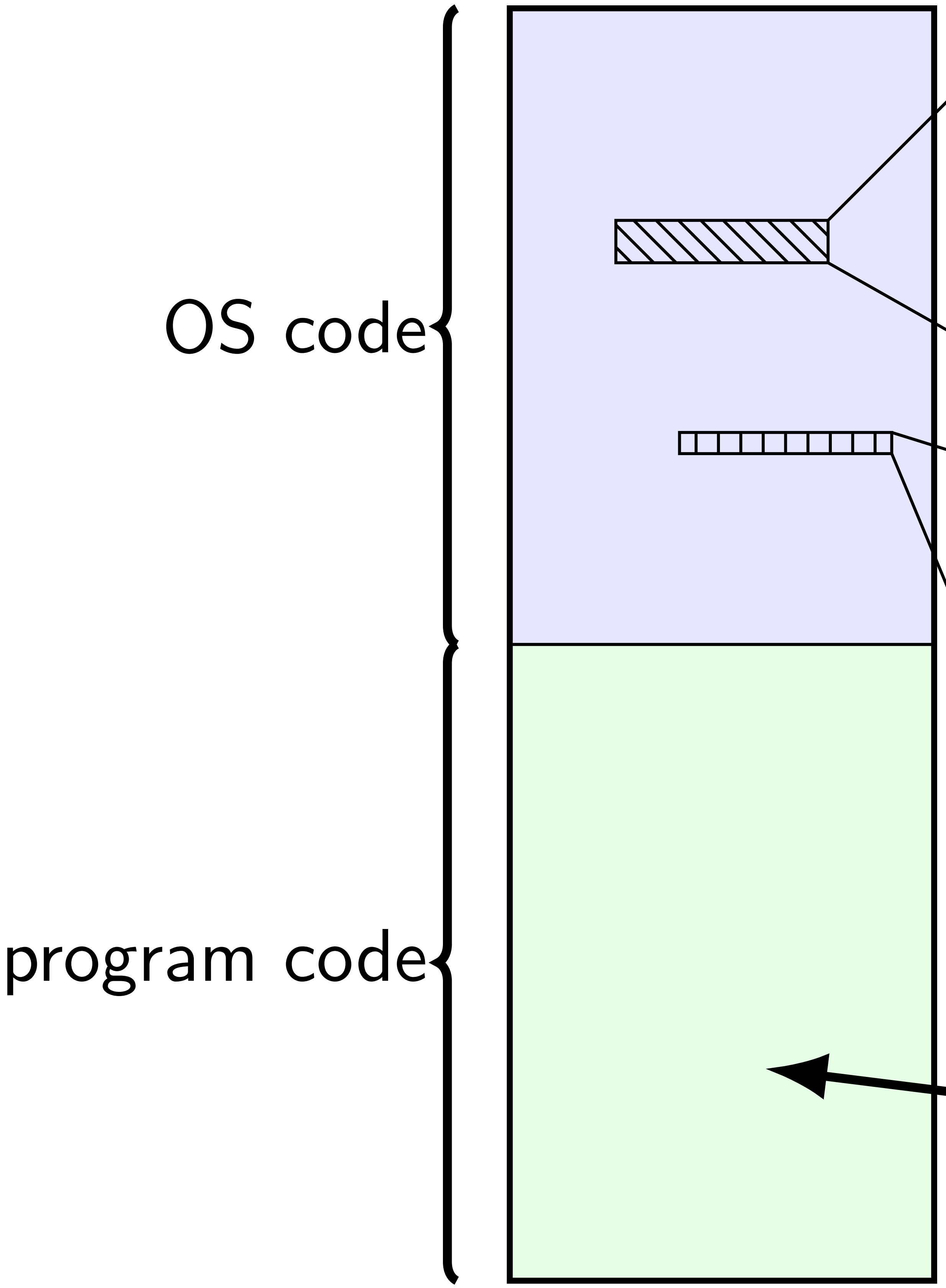
next topic: when does system switch back to kernel mode?

- how does OS tell HW where the (trusted) OS code is?

hardware + system call interface



calling the OS?




```
void readFromDiskInto(int diskLocation, char *dest) {
    ...
    runPrivilegedInstruction(...);
    ...
}
```

```
void readFileSafely(const char *name, char *dest) {
    if (canCurrentProgramCanAccessFile(name)) {
        readFromDiskInto(lookupFile(name), dest)
    }
}
```

how do we let this code run
`readFileSafely` in kernel mode
but not `readFromDisk`?

controlled entry to kernel mode (1)

special instruction: “make system call”

- similar idea as `call` instruction — jump to function elsewhere
- (and allow that function to return later)

runs OS code in kernel mode at location specified earlier

OS sets up at boot

location can’t be changed without privilieged instrution

controlled entry to kernel mode (2)

OS needs to make specified location:

figure out what operation the program wants

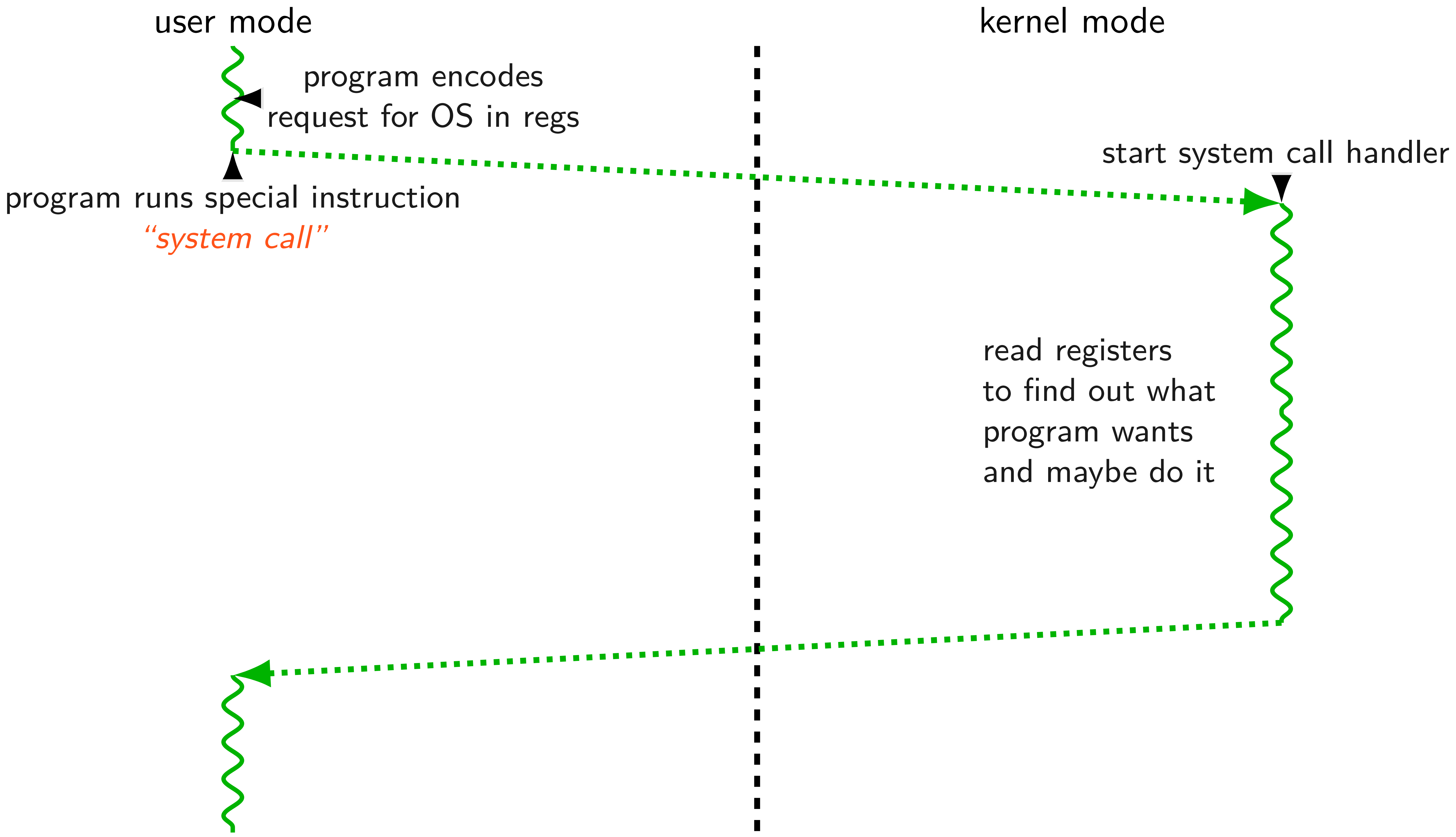
- calling convention, similar to function arguments + return value

be “safe” — not allow the program to do ‘bad’ things

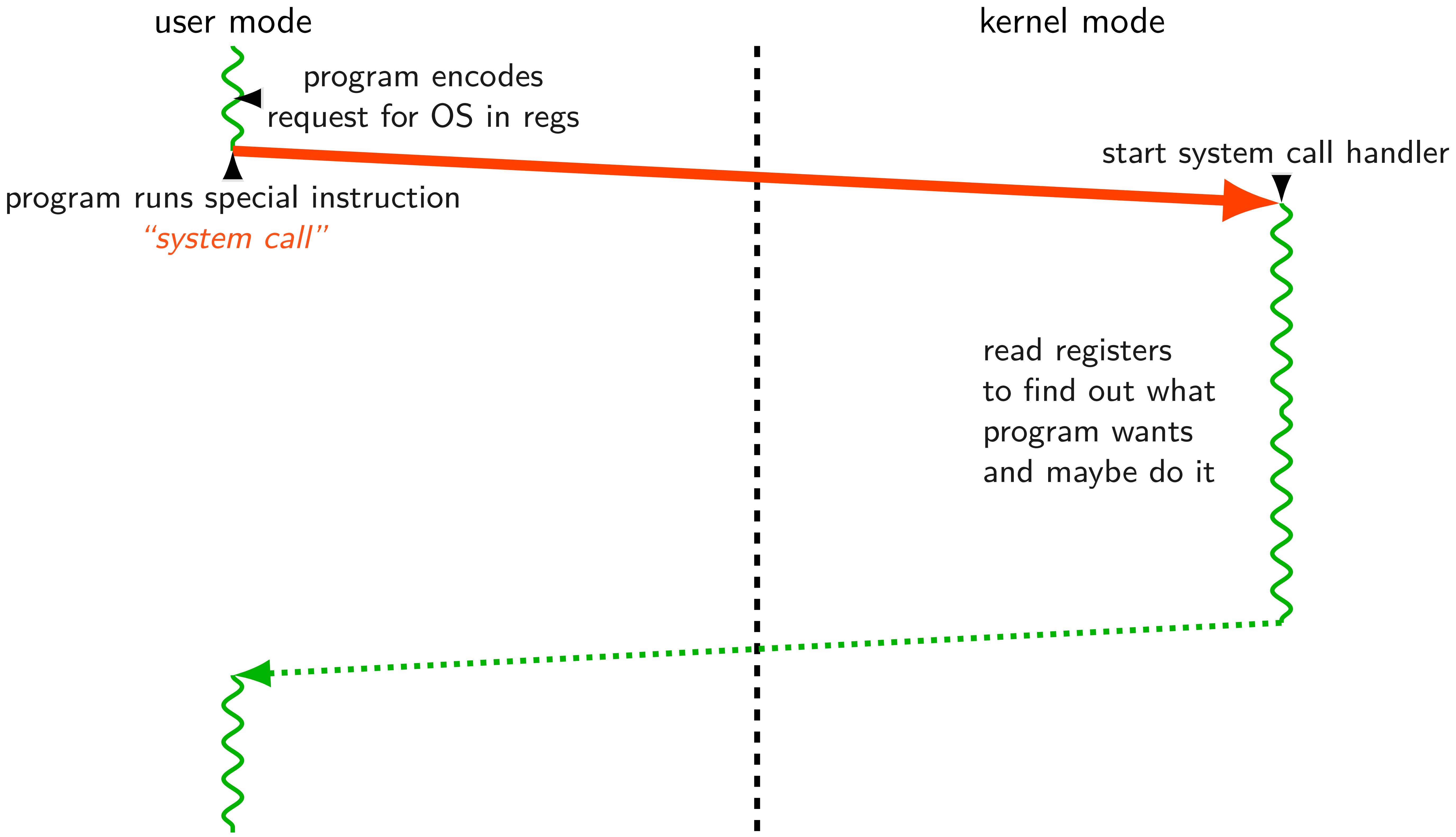
- example: checks whether current program is allowed to read file before reading it
- requires exceptional care — program can try weird things

system call process

system call process



system call process



system call terminology

some inconsistency:

system call = event of entering kernel mode on request?

system call = whole process from beginning to end?

same issue as with ‘function call’

- is it just starting the function, or the whole time the function runs?

Linux x86-64 system calls

special instruction: `syscall`

runs OS specified code in kernel mode

Linux syscall calling convention

before `syscall`:

`%rax` — system call number

`%rdi`, `%rsi`, `%rdx`, `%r10`, `%r8`, `%r9` — args

after `syscall`:

`%rax` — return value

on error: `%rax` contains -1 times “error number”

almost the same as normal function calls

Linux x86-64 hello world

```
.globl _start
.data
hello_str: .asciz "Hello, World!\n"
.text
_start:
  movq $1, %rax # 1 = "write"
  movq $1, %rdi # file descriptor 1 = stdout
  movq $hello_str, %rsi
  movq $15, %rdx # 15 = strlen("Hello, World!\n")
  syscall

  movq $60, %rax # 60 = exit
  movq $0, %rdi
  syscall
```

approx. system call handler

```
sys_call_table:
    .quad handle_read_syscall
    .quad handle_write_syscall
    // ...

handle_syscall:
    ... // save old PC, etc.
    pushq %rcx // save registers
    pushq %rdi
    ...
    call *sys_call_table(,%rax,8)
    ...
    popq %rdi
    popq %rcx
    return_from_exception
```

Linux system call examples

`mmap`, `brk` — allocate memory

`fork` — create new process

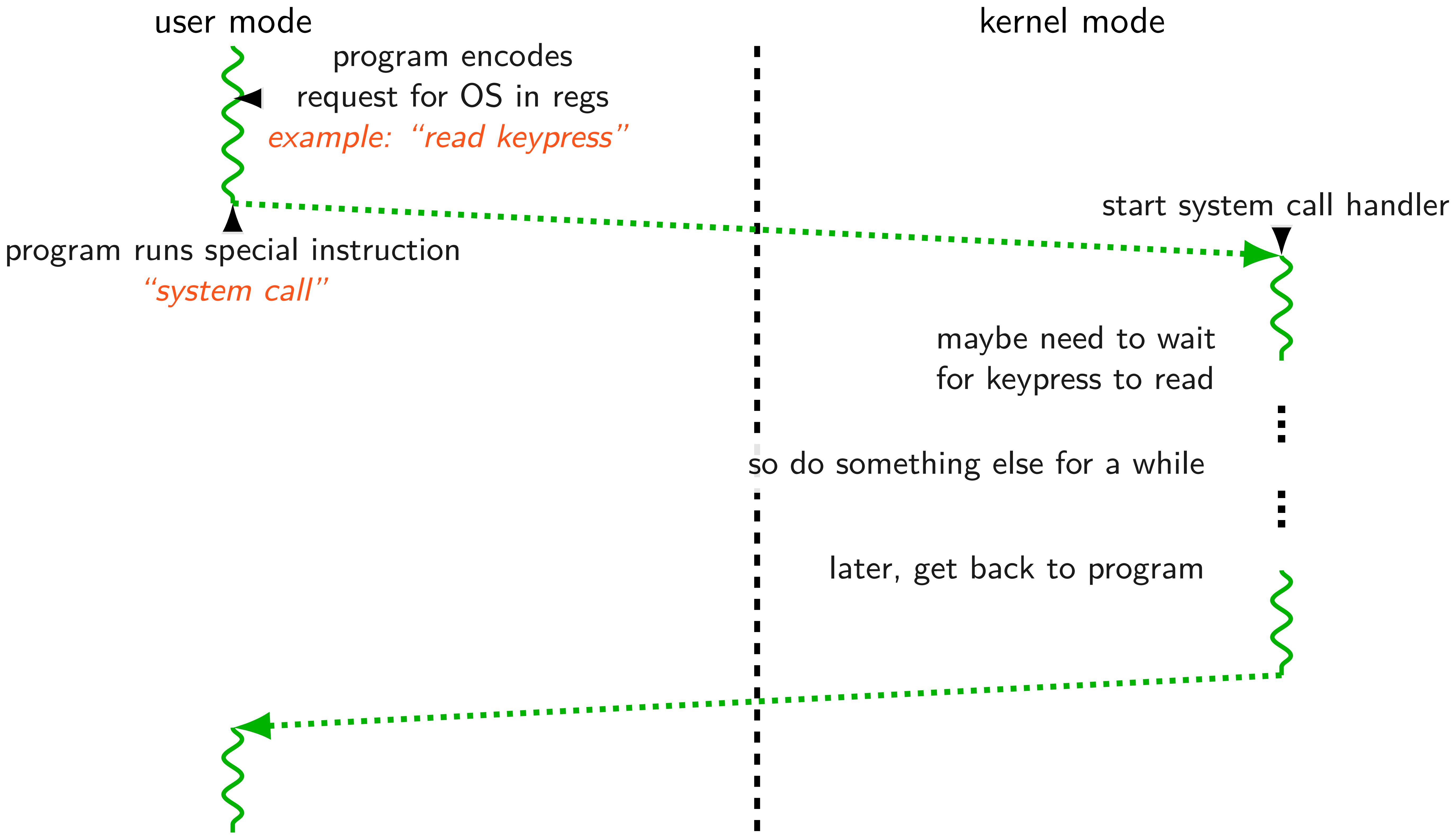
`execve` — run a program in the current process

`open`, `read`, `write` — access files

`_exit` — terminate a process

`socket`, `accept`, `getpeername` — socket-related

system call handled slowly?



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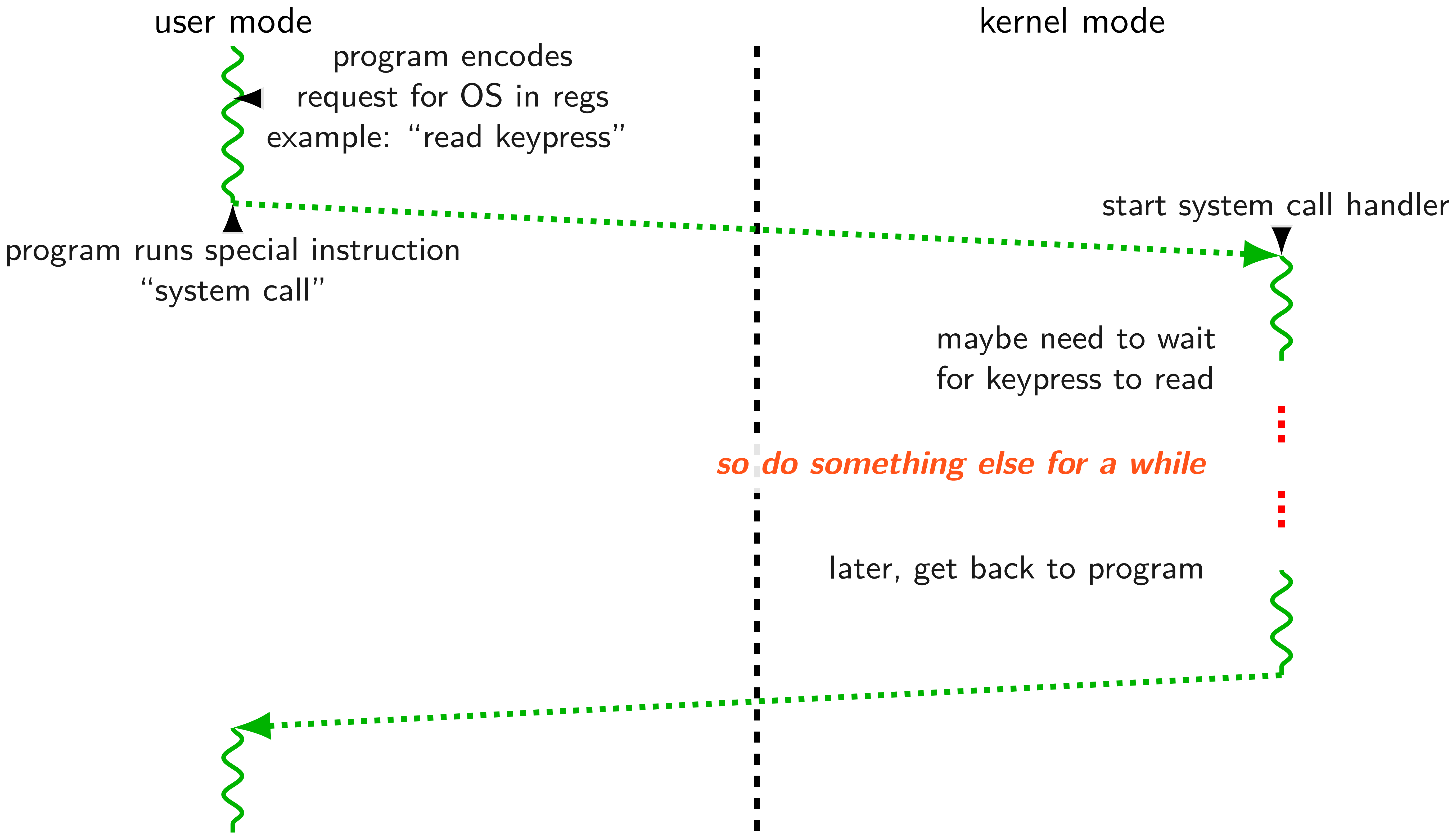

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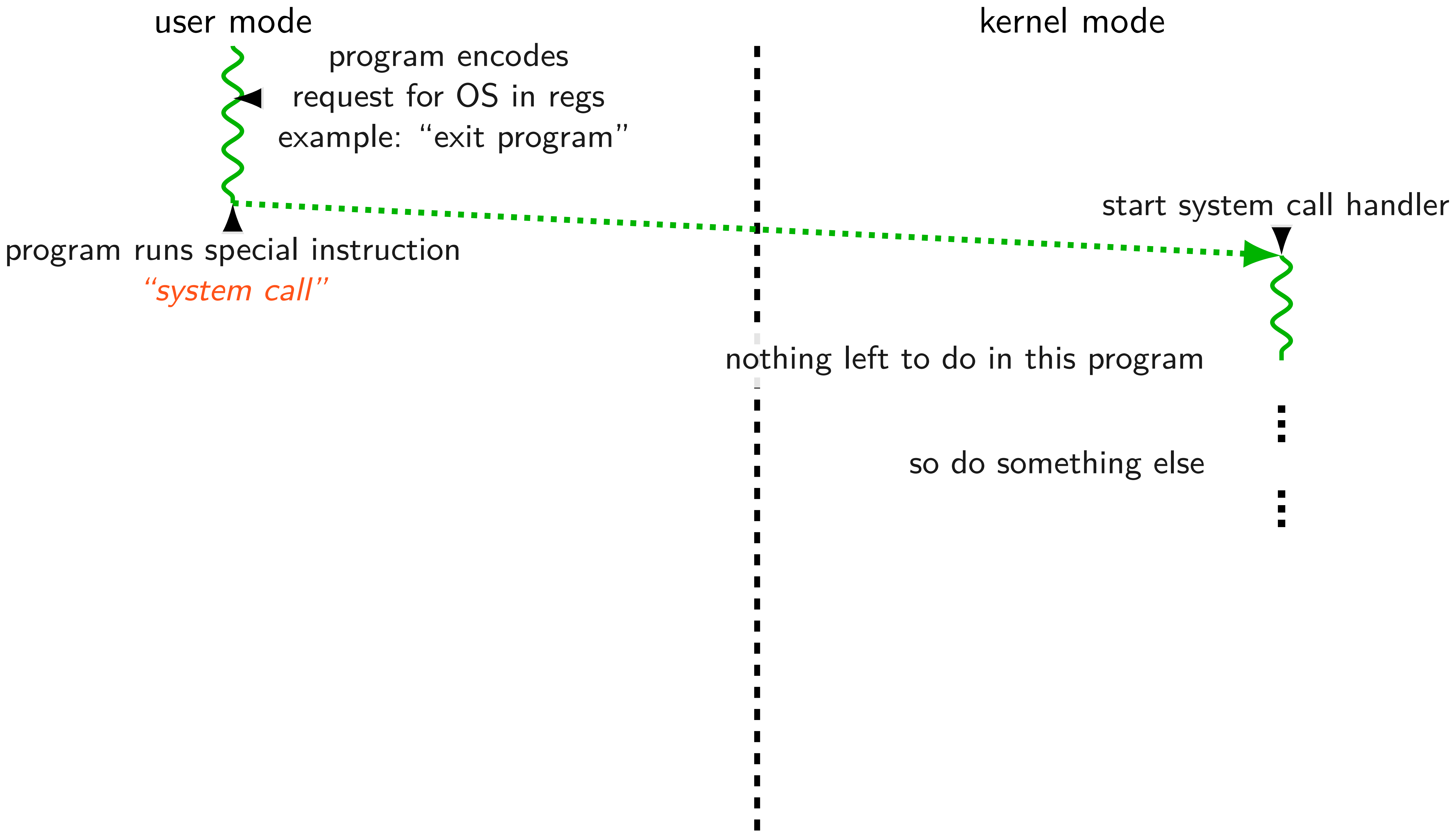

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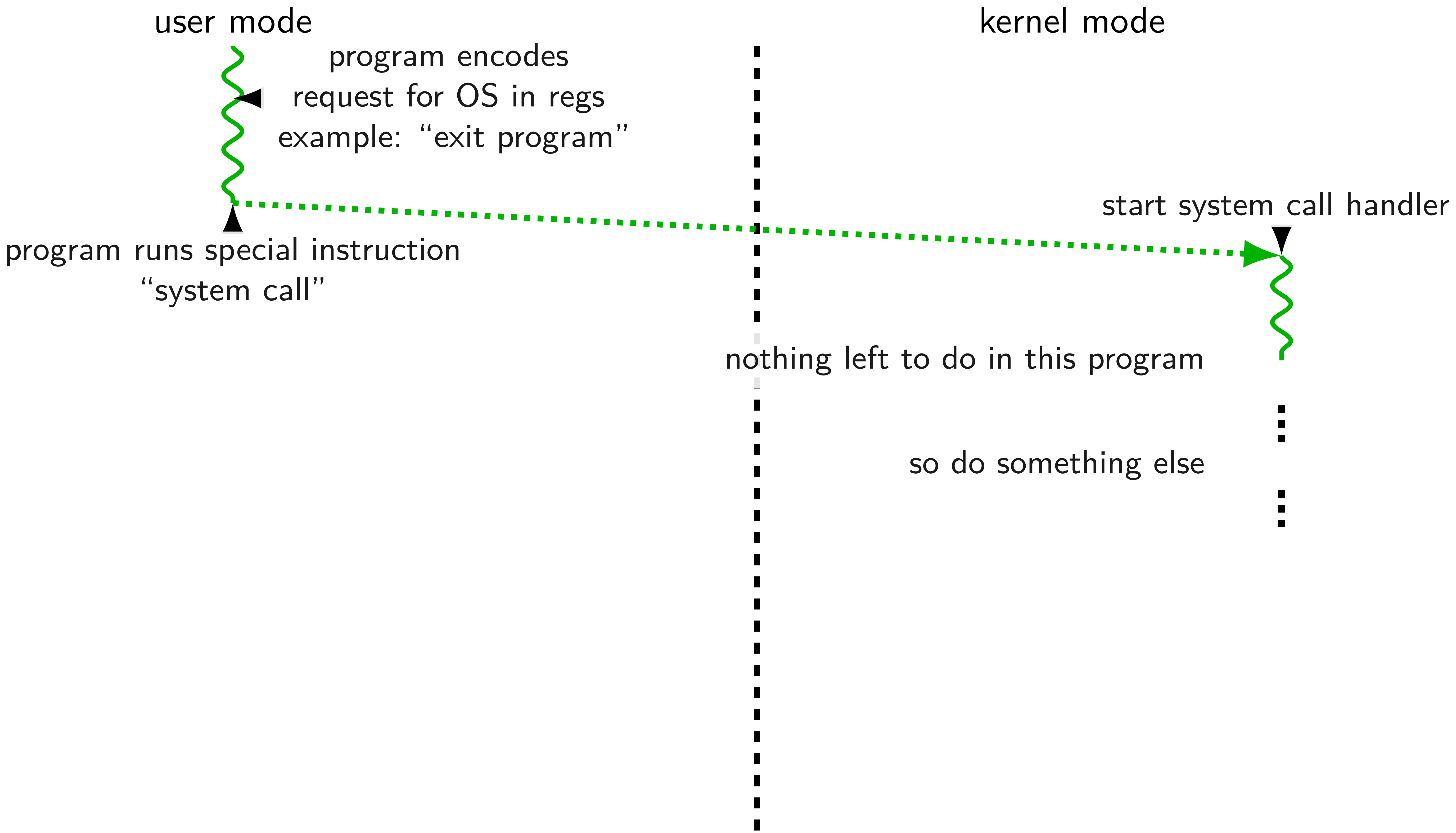

system call wrappers

library functions to not write assembly:

```
open:
    movq $2, %rax // 2 = sys_open
    // 2 arguments happen to use same registers
    syscall
    // return value in %eax
    cmp $0, %rax
    jl has_error
    ret
has_error:
    neg %rax
    movq %rax, errno
    movq $-1, %rax
    ret
```

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```

system call wrapper: usage

```
/*  unistd.h contains definitions of:
    O_RDONLY (integer constant), open() */
#include <unistd.h>
int main(void) {
  int file_descriptor;
  file_descriptor = open("input.txt", O_RDONLY);
  if (file_descriptor < 0) {
      printf("error: %s\n", strerror(errno));
      exit(1);
  }
  ...
  result = read(file_descriptor, ...);
  ...
}
```

system call wrapper: usage

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system call wrapper: usage

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      exit(1);
  }
  ...
  result = read(file_descriptor, ...);
  ...
}
```

strace hello_world (1)

`strace` — Linux tool to trace system calls

run on assembly program we saw earlier:

```
$ strace -o trace.txt ./hello_world
$ cat trace.txt
execve("./hello_world", ["./hello_world"],
        0x7ffeedafd0a0 /* 28 vars */) = 0
write(1, "Hello, World!\n\0", 14)       = 14
exit(0)                                 = ?
+++ exited with 0 +++
```

strace hello_world (2)

```c
#include <stdio.h>
int main() { puts("Hello, World!"); }
```

when statically linked:

```
execve("./hello_world", ["./hello_world"], 0x7ffeb4127f70 /* 28 vars */)
                                        = 0
brk(NULL)                               = 0x22f8000
brk(0x22f91c0)                          = 0x22f91c0
arch_prctl(ARCH_SET_FS, 0x22f8880)      = 0
uname({sysname="Linux", nodename="reiss-t3620", ...}) = 0
readlink("/proc/self/exe", "/u/cr4bd/spring2023/cs3130/slide"..., 4096)
                                        = 57
brk(0x231a1c0)                          = 0x231a1c0
brk(0x231b000)                          = 0x231b000
access("/etc/ld.so.nohwcap", F_OK)      = -1 ENOENT (No such file or
                                                     directory)
fstat(1, {st_mode=S_IFCHR|0620, st_rdev=makedev(136, 4), ...}) = 0
write(1, "Hello, World!\n", 14)         = 14
exit_group(0)                           = ?
+++ exited with 0 +++
```

aside: what are those syscalls?

execve: run program

brk: allocate heap space

arch_prctl(ARCH_SET_FS, ...): thread local storage pointer

- may make more sense when we cover concurrency/parallelism later

uname: get system information

readlink of /proc/self/exe: get name of this program

access: can we access this file [in this case, a config file]?

fstat: get information about open file

exit_group: variant of exit

strace hello_world (2)

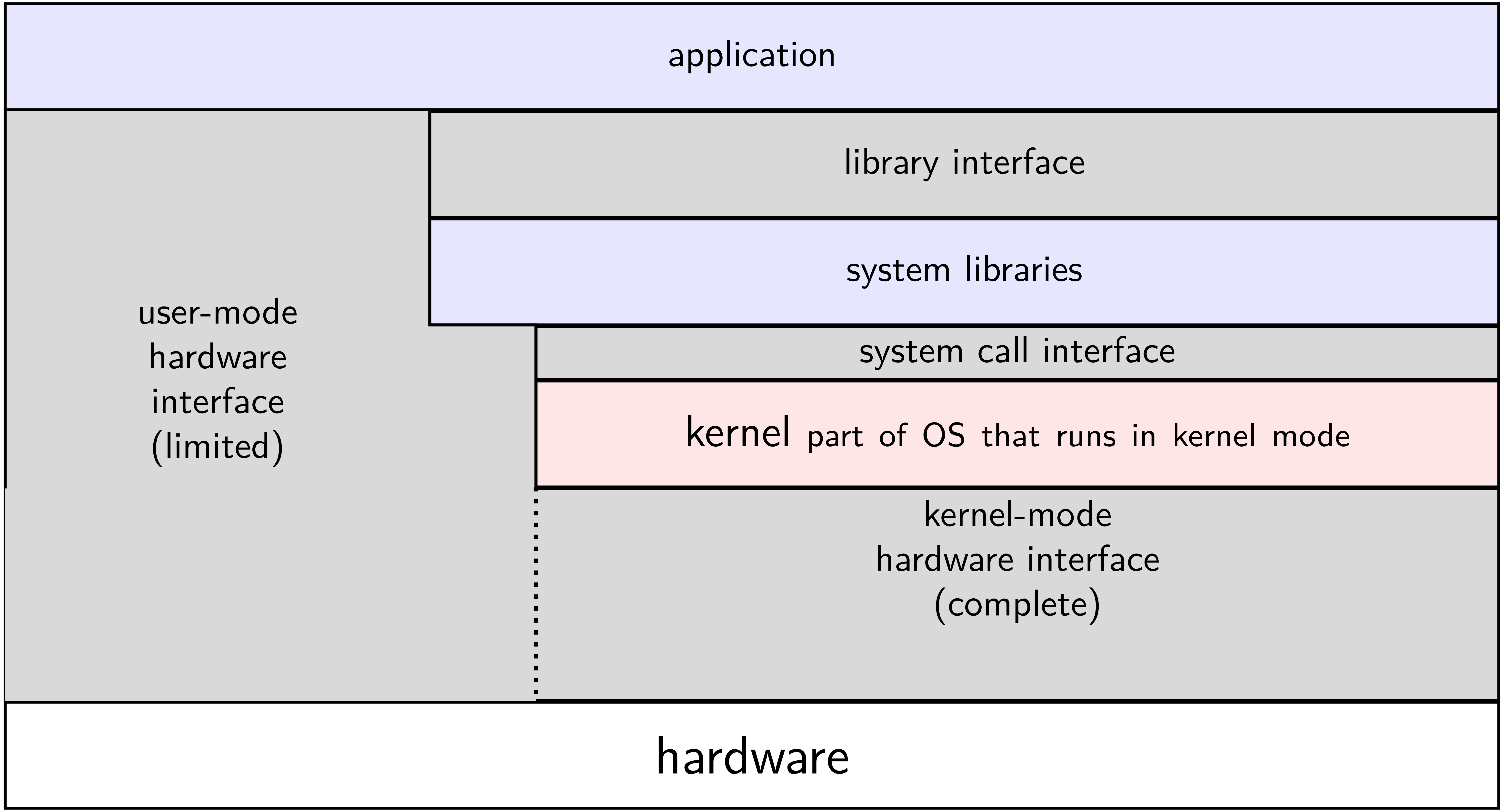
```
#include <stdio.h>
int main() { puts("Hello, World!"); }
```

---

when dynamically linked:

```
execve("./hello_world", ["./hello_world"], 0x7ffcfe91d540 /* 28 vars */)
                                        = 0
brk(NULL)                               = 0x55d6c351b000
...
openat(AT_FDCWD, "/etc/ld.so.cache", O_RDONLY|O_CLOEXEC) = 3
fstat(3, {st_mode=S_IFREG|0644, st_size=196684, ...}) = 0
mmap(NULL, 196684, PROT_READ, MAP_PRIVATE, 3, 0) = 0x7f7a62dd3000
close(3)                                = 0
access("/etc/ld.so.nohwcap", F_OK)      = -1 ENOENT (No such file or directory)
openat(AT_FDCWD, "/lib/x86_64-linux-gnu/libc.so.6", O_RDONLY|O_CLOEXEC) = 3
read(3, "\177ELF\2\1\1\3\0\0\0\0\0\0\0\0\3\0>\0\1\0\0\0"..., 832) = 832
...
close(3)                                = 0
write(1, "Hello, World!\n", 14)         = 14
exit_group(0)                           = ?
+++ exited with 0 +++
```

hardware + system call + library interface



things programs on portal shouldn't do

read other user's files

modify OS's memory

read other user's data in memory

hang the entire system

memory protection

program 1

```c
long global = 42;
main() {
    printf("%p", &global);
    // 0x410010
    ...
    printf("%ld\n", global);
}
```

program 2

```c
// while program 1 is in ...:
long *ptr;
ptr = (long*) 0x410010;
*ptr = 100;
```

What happens?

A. 42 is printed

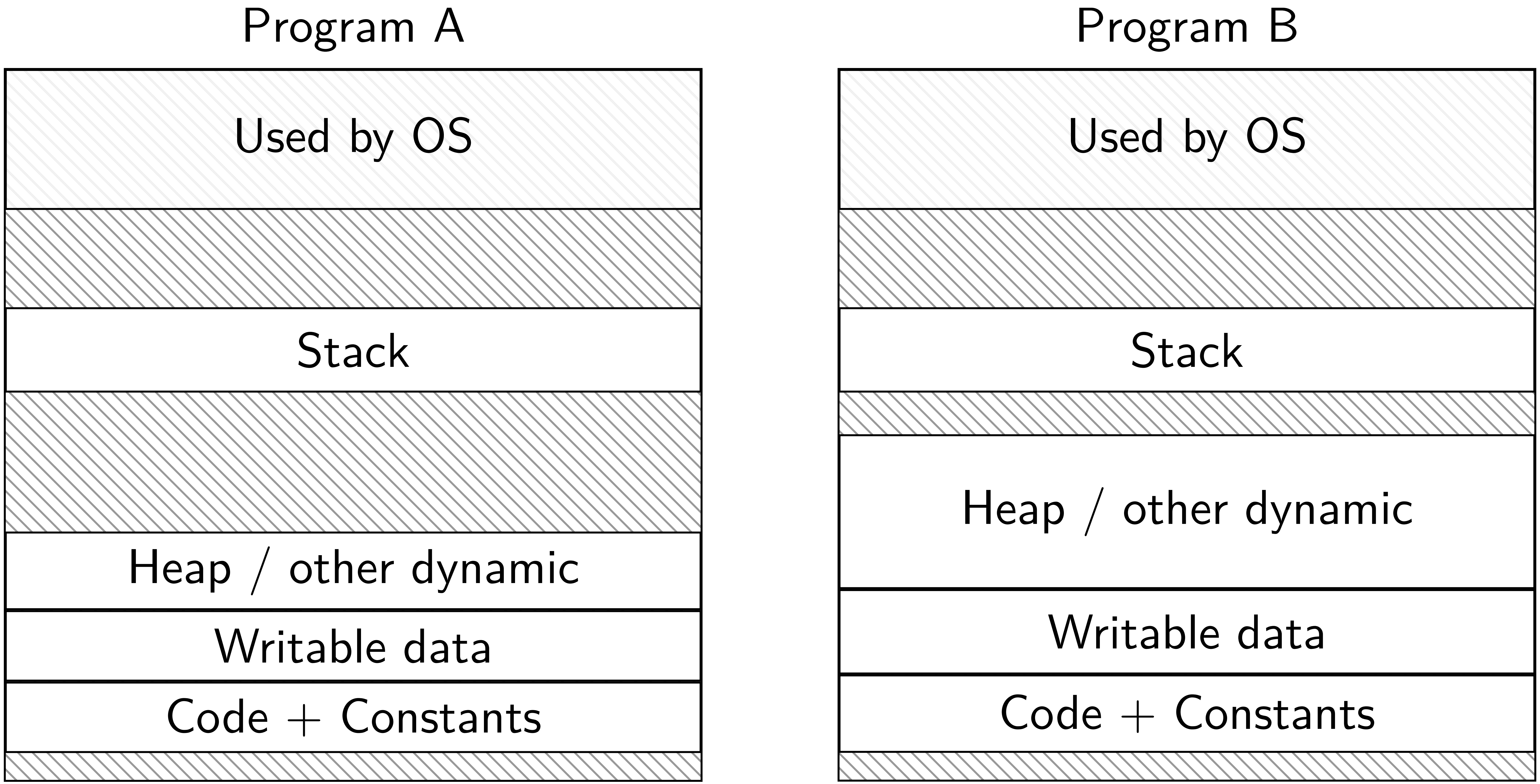
B. 100 is printed

C. program 1 crashes

D. program 2 crashes

E. something else

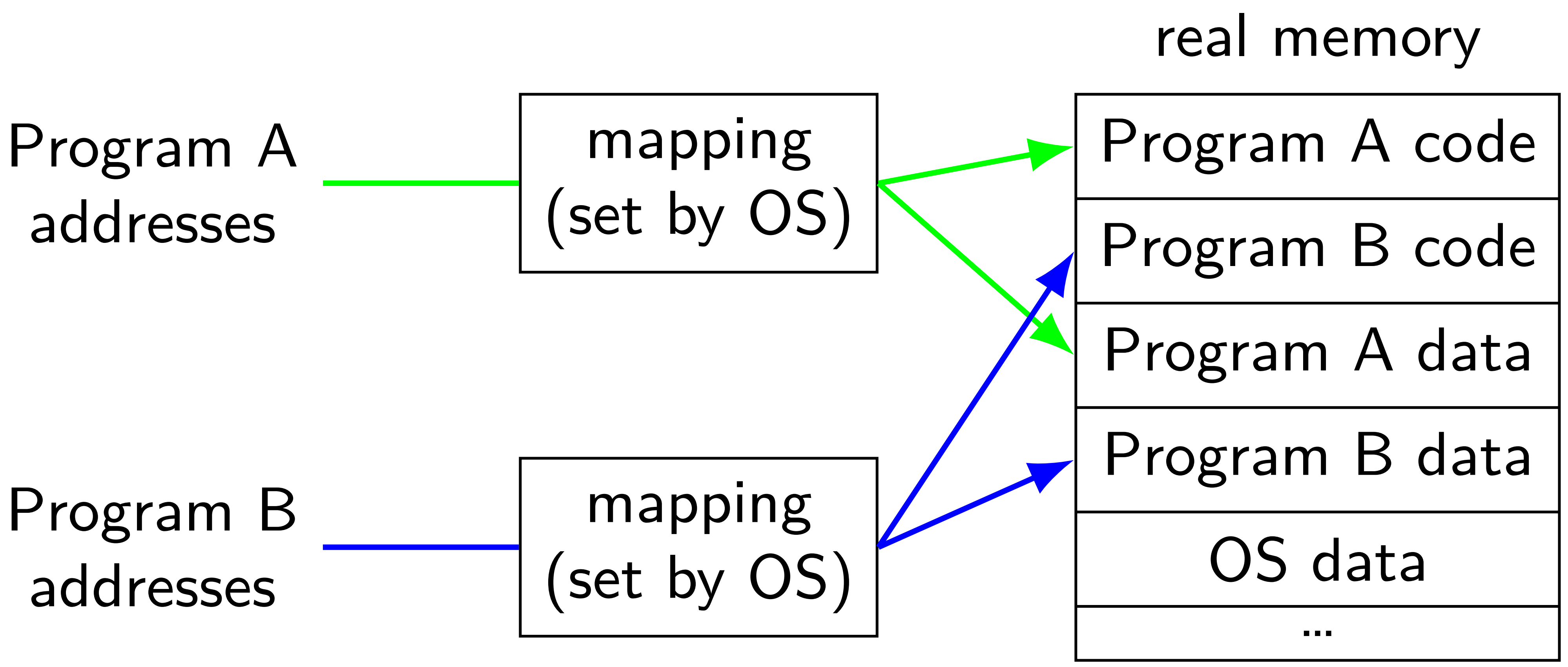
program memory (two programs)



address space

programs have *illusion of own memory*

called a program's *address space*



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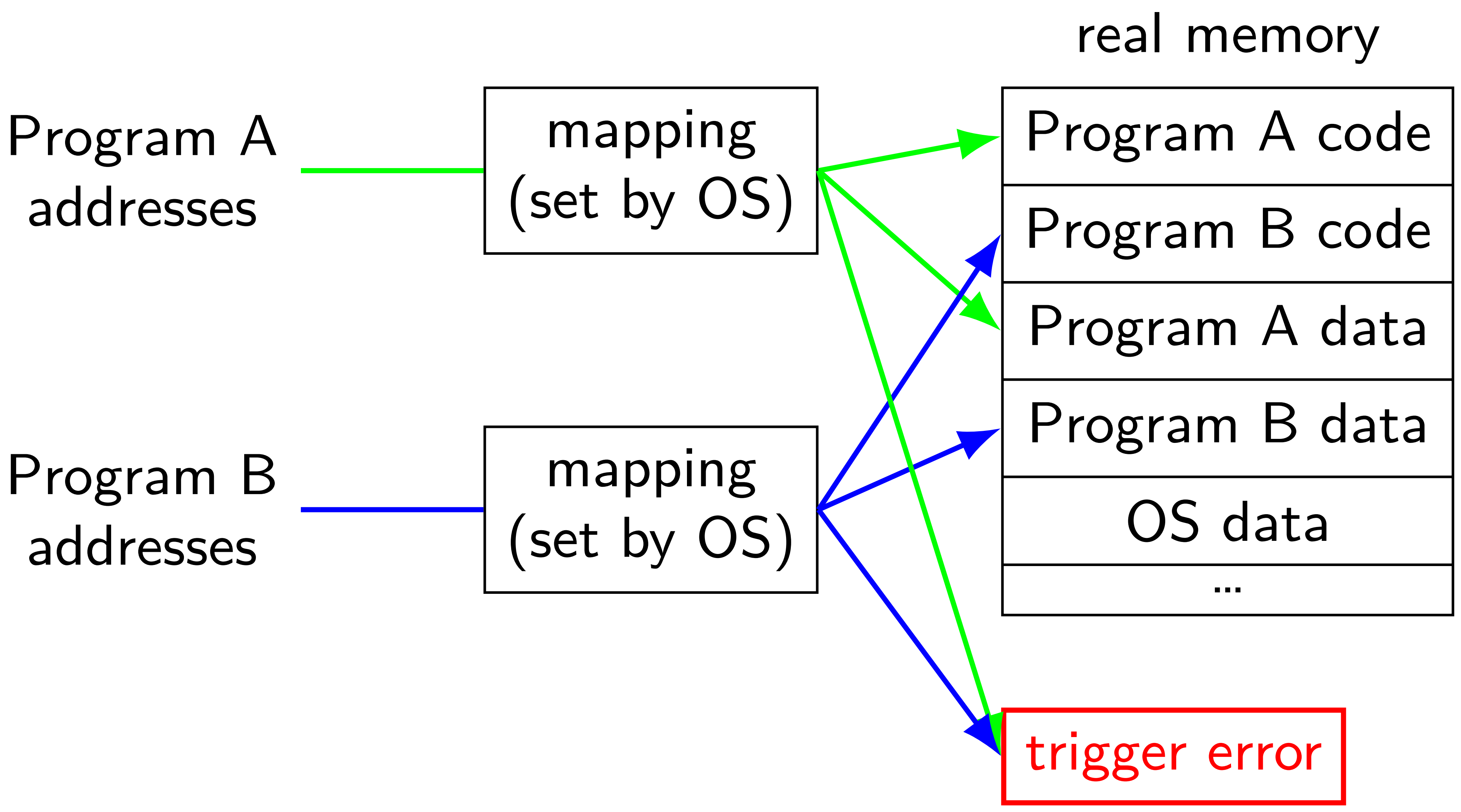

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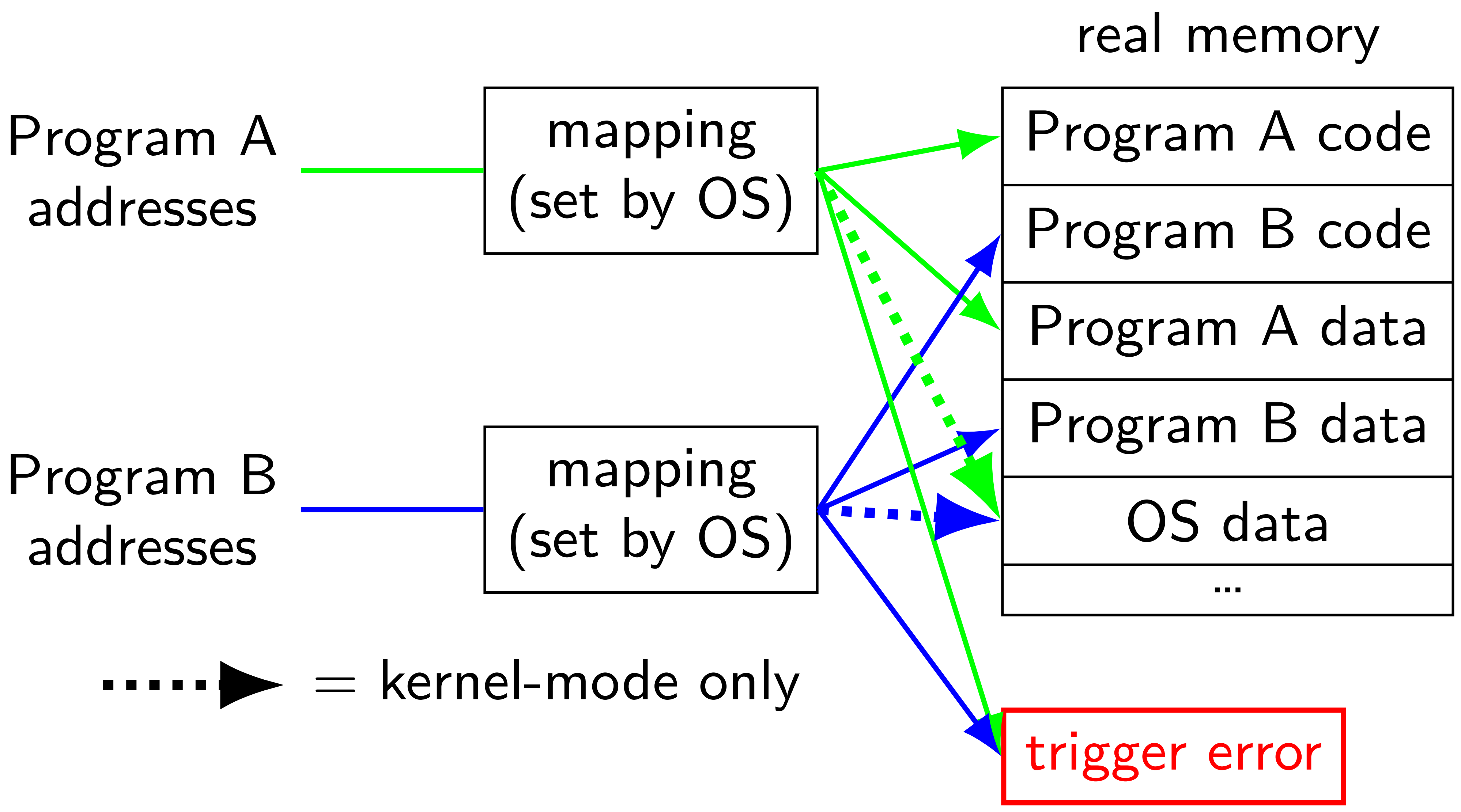

address space mechanisms

topic after exceptions

called *virtual memory*

mapping called *page tables*

mapping part of what is changed in context switch

program crashing?

what happens on processor when program crashes?

other program informed of crash to display message

use processor to run some other program

how does hardware do this?

would be complicated to tell about other programs, etc.

instead: hardware runs designated OS routine

exceptions

recall: system calls — software asks OS for help

also cases where hardware asks OS for help

different triggers than system calls

but same mechanism as system calls:
- switch to kernel mode (if not already)
- call OS-designated function (configured at boot)

exceptions

recall: system calls — software asks OS for help

also cases where hardware asks OS for help

different triggers than system calls

but *same mechanism as system calls*:
- switch to kernel mode (if not already)
- call OS-designated function (configured at boot)

types of exceptions

- system calls
  - intentional — ask OS to do something

types of exceptions

system calls

- intentional — ask OS to do something

errors/events in programs

- memory not in address space (“Segmentation fault”)
- privileged instruction
- divide by zero, invalid instruction
- …

types of exceptions

- system calls
  - intentional — ask OS to do something
- errors/events in programs
  - memory not in address space (“Segmentation fault”)
  - privileged instruction
  - divide by zero, invalid instruction
  - …
- external — I/O, etc.
  - timer
  - I/O devices
  - hardware is broken (e.g. memory parity error)

types of exceptions

synchornous

triggered by current program

system calls
- intentional — ask OS to do something

errors/events in programs
- memory not in address space (“Segmentation fault”)
- privileged instruction
- divide by zero, invalid instruction
- …

asynchornous

not triggered by running program

external — I/O, etc.
- timer
- I/O devices
- hardware is broken (e.g. memory parity error)

things programs on portal shouldn't do

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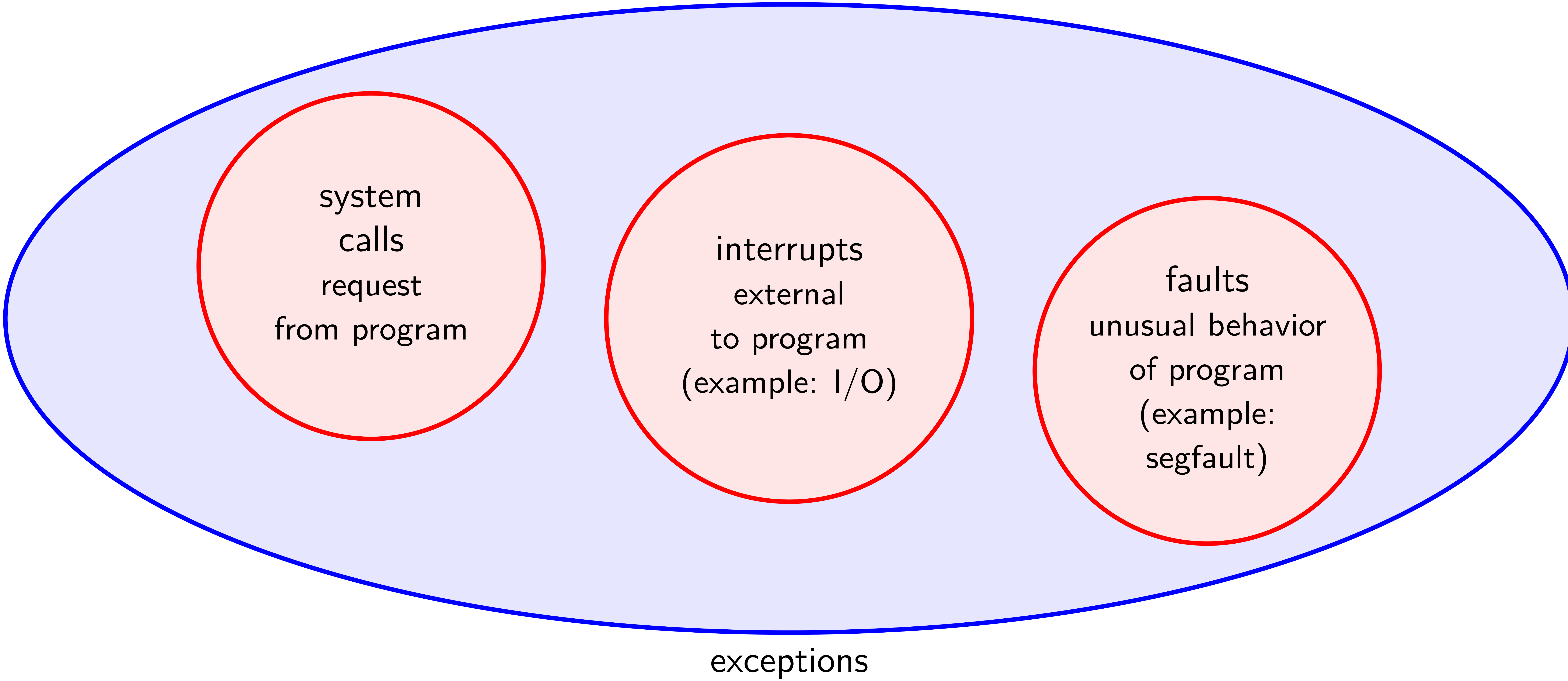
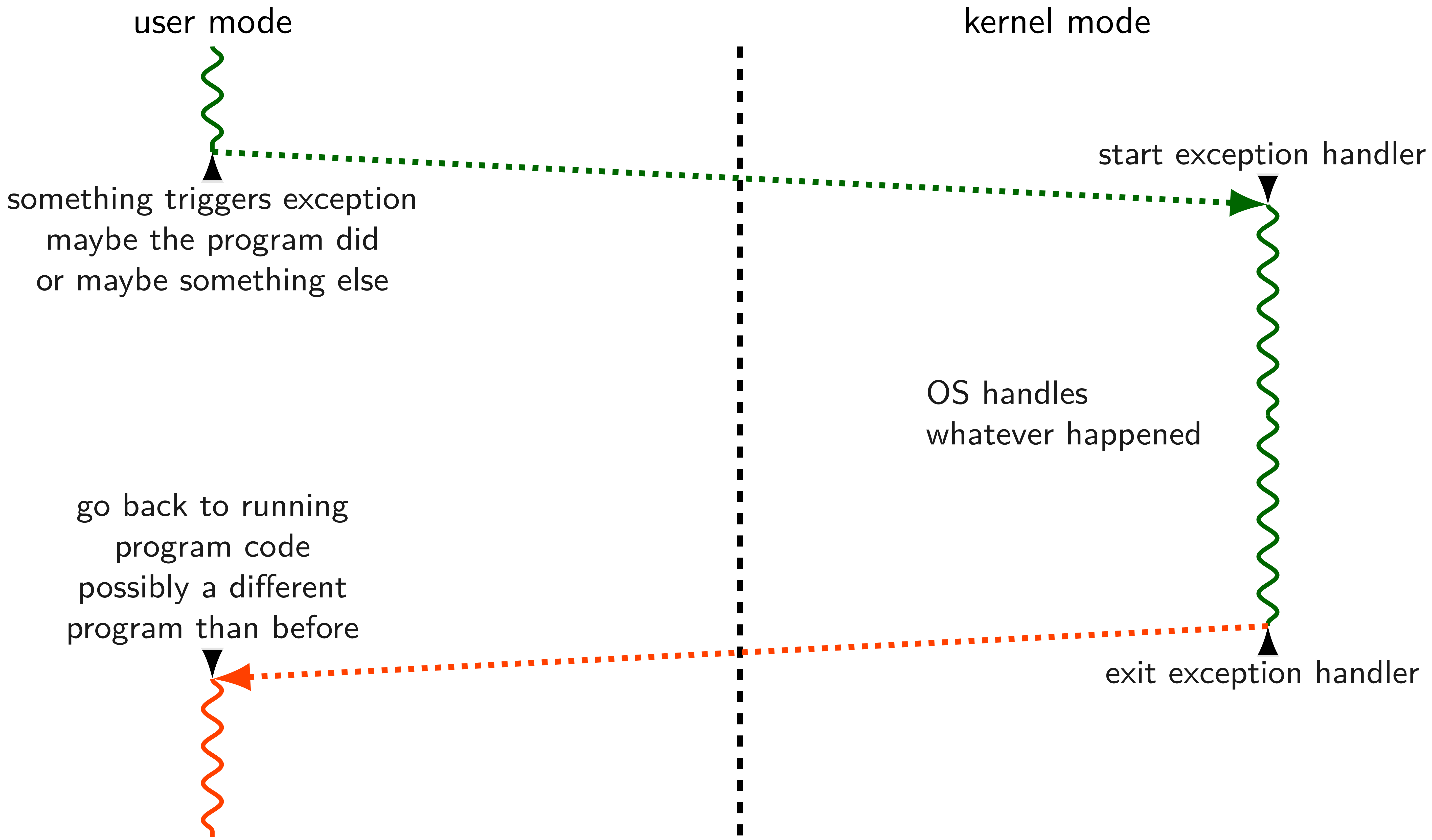
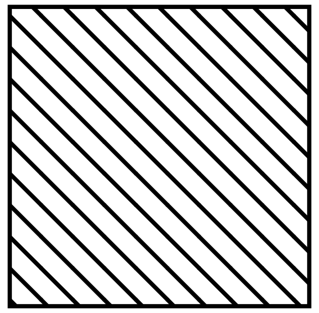
exceptions [Venn diagram]



general exception process

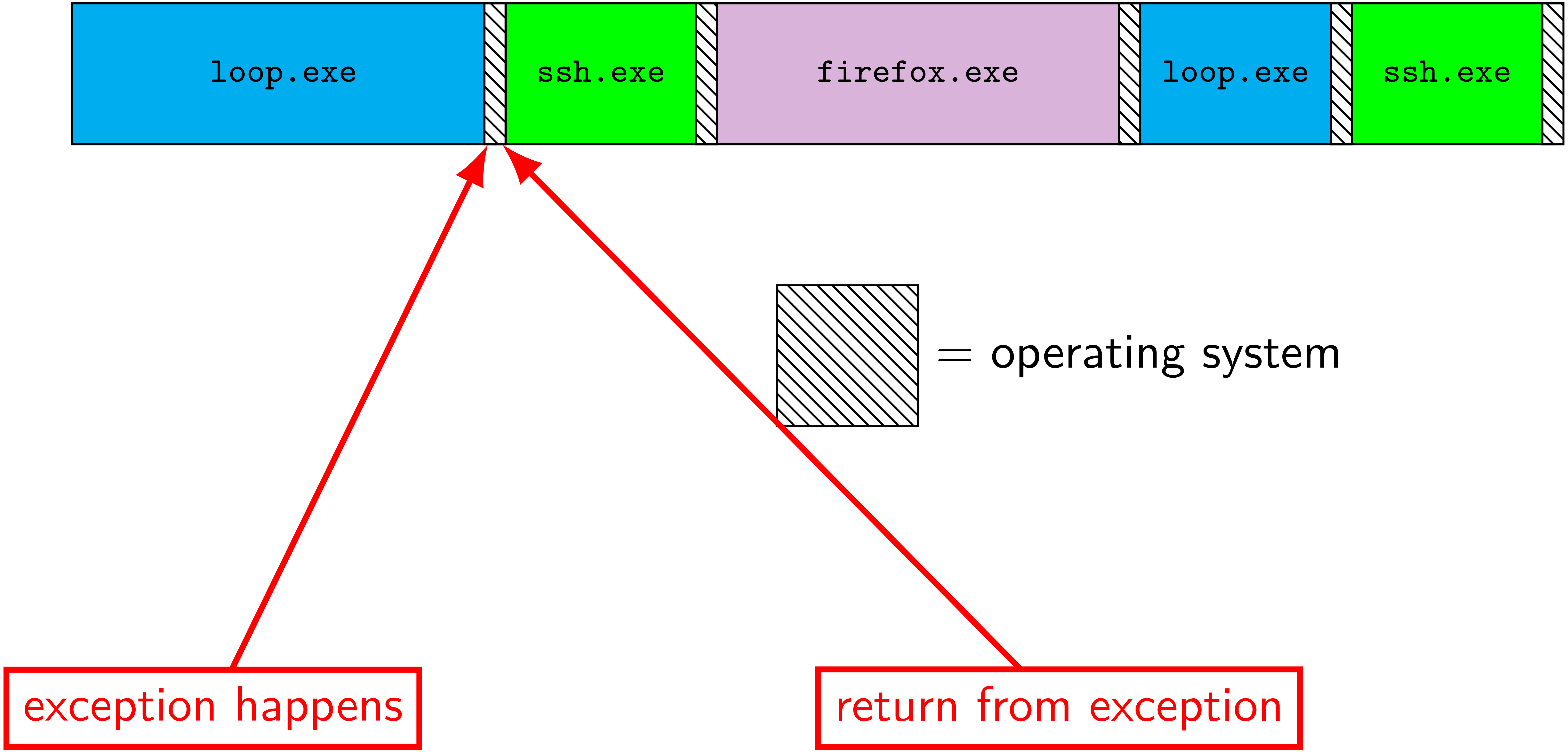


time multiplexing



= operating system

time multiplexing



switching programs

OS starts running somehow

- some sort of exception

saves old registers + program counter + address mapping

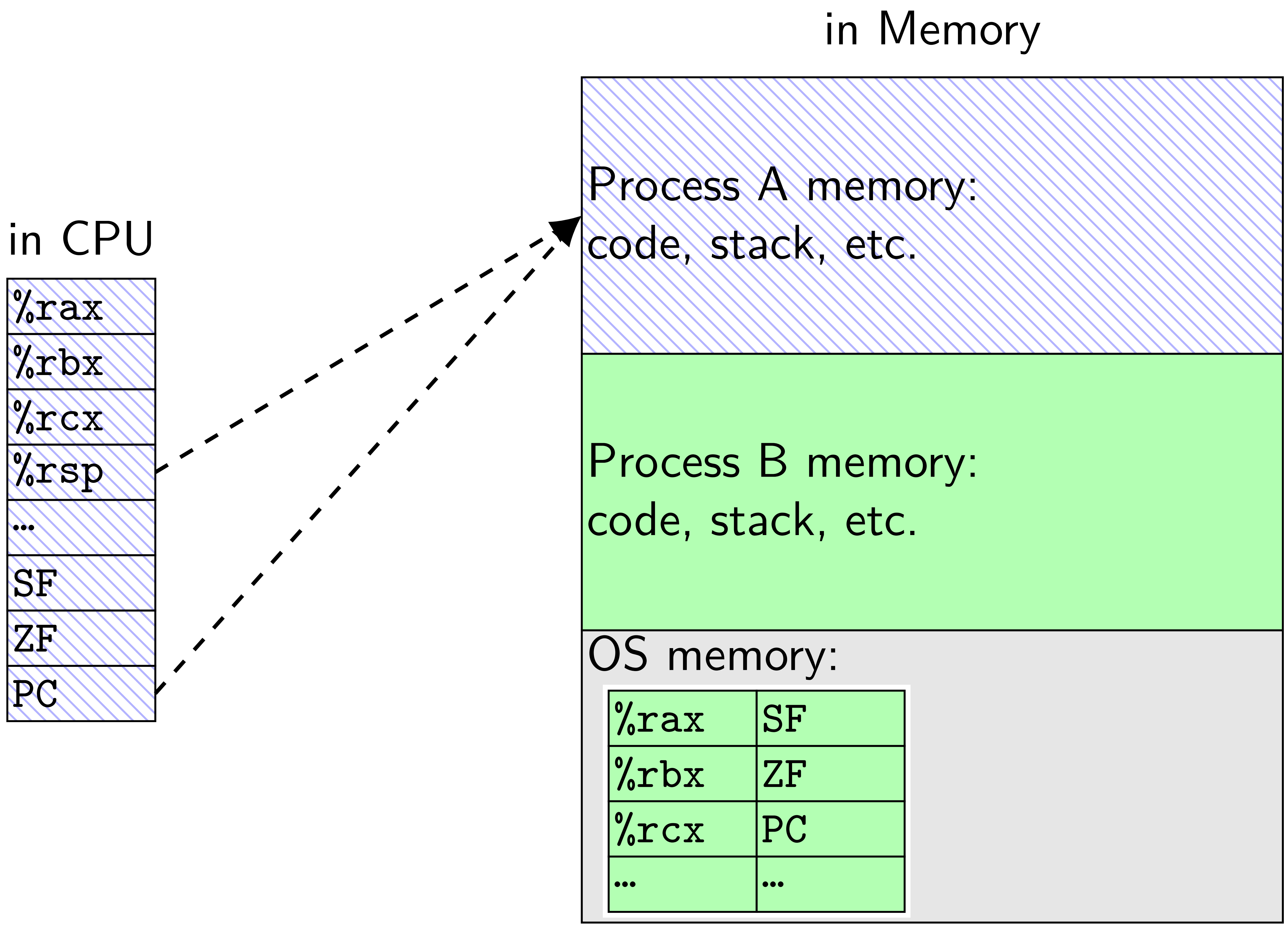
- (optimization: could omit when program crashing/exiting)

sets new registers + address mapping, jumps to new program counter

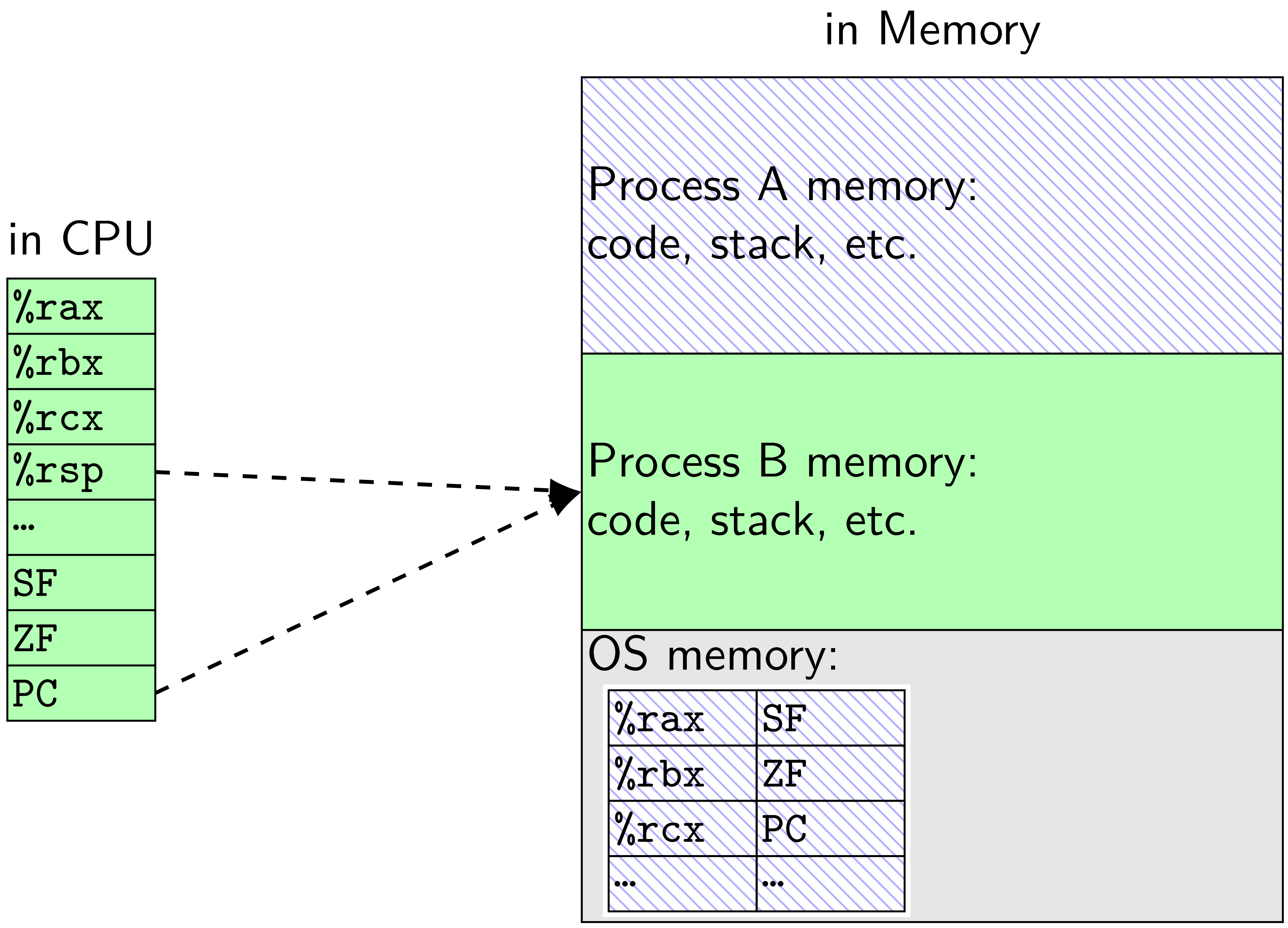
called *context switch*

- saved information called *context*

contexts (A running)



contexts (B running)



threads

thread = illusion of own processor

own register values

own program counter value

actual implementation:
many threads sharing one processor
- problem: where are register/program counter values when thread not active on processor?

exception patterns with I/O (1)

input — available now:

- exception: device says "I have input now"
- handler: OS stores input for later
- exception (syscall): program says "I want to read input"
- handler: OS returns that input

input — not available now:

- exception (syscall): program says "I want to read input"
- handler: OS runs other things (context switch)
- exception: device says "I have input now"
- handler: OS retrieves input
- handler: (possibly) OS switches back to program that wanted it

exception patterns with I/O (2)

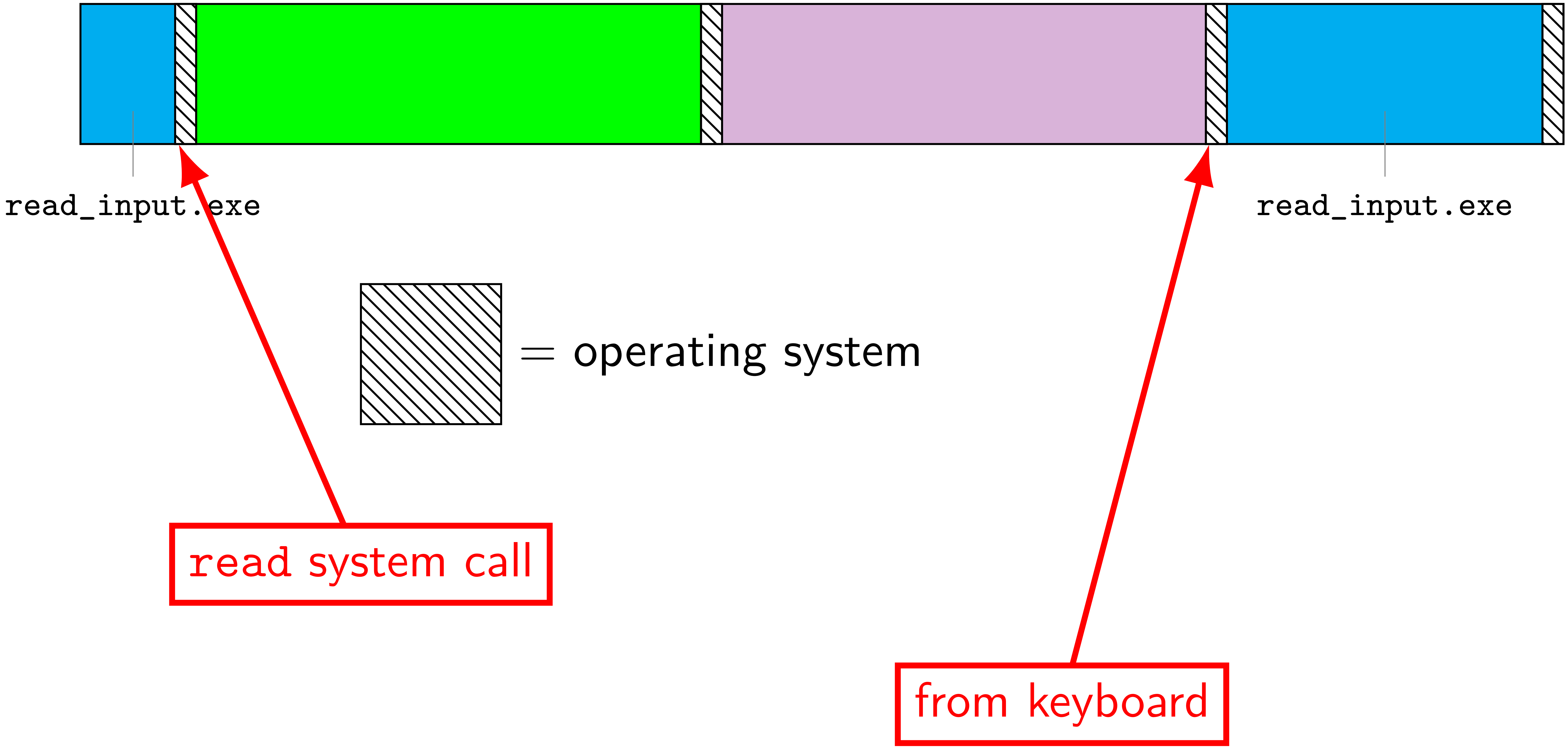
output — ready now:

- exception (syscall): program says ‘`I want to output this’
- handler: OS sends output to device

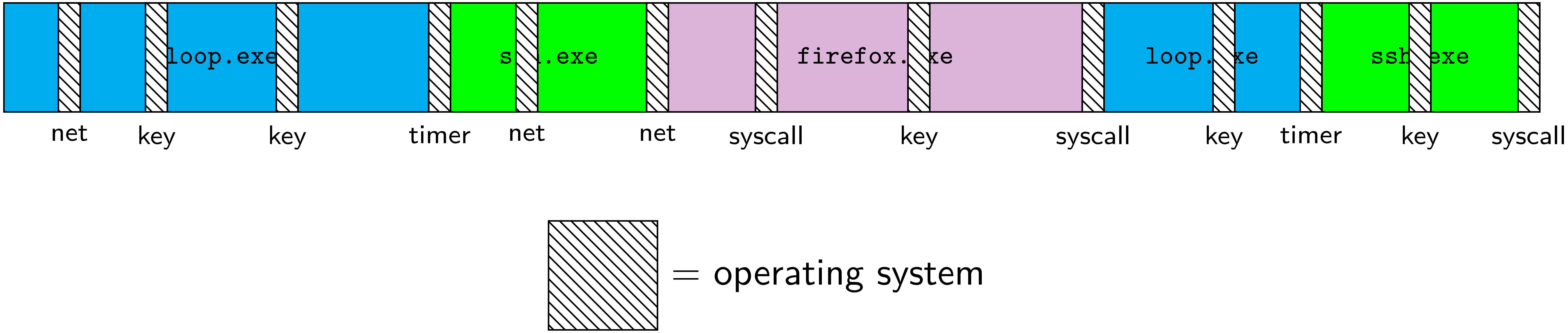
output — not ready now

- exception (syscall): program says “I want to output”
- handler: OS realizes device can’t accept output yet
- (other things happen)
- exception: device says “I’m ready for output now”
- handler: OS sends output requested earlier

keyboard input timeline



context switches and exceptions



program execution interleaves with OS

OS might context switch when it is run, might not

emptyloop lab (1)

```
long last_time = GetTime();
while (NotDone()) {
    long current_time = GetTime();
    RecordDelta(current_time - last_time);
    last_time = current_time;
}
```

naive computer model:

RecordDelta called with roughly same number each time

emptyloop lab (2)

```
long last_time = GetTime();
while (NotDone()) {
    long current_time = GetTime();
    /* maybe OS handles I/O here? */
    /* maybe OS runs ssh for a bit here? */
    /* ... */
    RecordDelta(current_time - last_time);
    last_time = current_time;
}
```

will see spikes in recorded times from exceptions

can infer what system is doing

emptyloop lab (3)

upcoming lab: we'll supply program that times in loop

also will look at Linux counters for asynchronous exceptions

should be able to observe when OS/other programs run

(and about how long)

review: definitions

exception: hardware calls OS specified routine

- many possible reasons
- system calls: type of exception

context switch: OS switches to another thread

- by saving old register values + loading new ones
- part of OS routine run by exception
- OS won't know it wants to do this when exception happens

which of these require exceptions? context switches?

A. program calls a function in the standard library

B. program writes a file to disk

C. program A goes to sleep, letting program B run

D. program exits

E. program returns from one function to another function

F. program pops a value from the stack

which require exceptions [answers] (1)

A. program calls a function in the standard library

no (same as other functions in program); many standard library functions make no system calls (and do not otherwise trigger exceptions — for example `strlen`, `pow`; also if we consider the calling of a function just the `call` instruction, then the library functions that *do* make system calls won't do so until later)

B. program writes a file to disk

yes (requires kernel mode only operations)

C. program A goes to sleep, letting program B run

yes (kernel mode usually required to change the address space to acess program B's memory)

which require exceptions [answer] (2)

D. program exits

    yes (requires switching to another program, which requires accessing OS data + other program's memory)

E. program returns from one function to another function

    no

F. program pops a value from the stack

    no

which require context switches [answer]

no: A. program calls a function in the standard library

no: B. program writes a file to disk

(but might be done if program needs to wait for disk and other things could be run while it does)

yes: C. program A goes to sleep, letting program B run

yes: D. program exits

no: E. program returns from one function to another function

no: F. program pops a value from the stack

terms for exceptions

terms for exceptions aren’t standardized

our readings use one set of terms

- interrupts = externally-triggered
- faults = error/event in program
- trap = intentionally triggered

all these terms appear differently elsewhere

The Process

process = thread(s) + address space

illusion of *dedicated machine*:

- thread = illusion of own CPU
- (process could have multiple threads — with independent registers)
- address space = illusion of own memory